sides at other disputed areas such as Gogra Hot Springs, Depsang Plains and south Pangong Tso lake, but the loss of lives had not been reported.

In order to keep the LAC area peaceful and to ensure no such deadly fights occur in the future, both countries undertook several rounds of talks between senior military officials and bilateral talks between diplomats. In the middle of a pandemic ripping through the world, the idea of the world's two most populous nations and the planet's two largest military forces at loggerheads with each other for weeks was very bad news, not only for both countries but also for the larger interest of humanity. Yet, India was not prepared to accept the territorial aggression which the PLA had been displaying akin to that in the South China Sea. In several of the disputed spots, the Chinese troops had inched closer and built temporary structures at patrolling points where the two countries had agreed not to engage. Though India was interested in peace and had made that abundantly clear to them in all global forums, it wasn't going to sit back and let its land be taken over by the Chinese. We were not going to be bullied this time around.

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30 JUNE 2020

INDIA | 2,20,493 ACTIVE CASES | 17,463 DEATHS

WORLD | 36,94,370 ACTIVE CASES | 5,72,879 DEATHS

The cases were on the rise, but India had managed to flatten the curve. The rise in cases was slow, gradual and the critical cases presenting themselves at hospitals were manageable due to the several infrastructural upgrades we had made over the last three months. However, a deeply eager Opposition along with its loyal ecosystem began to set a narrative that the government had flattened the wrong curve: the GDP curve versus the COVID-19 curve. Rahul Gandhi, best described by former president of the US, Barack Obama, as 'lacking aptitude or passion to master the subject'[4], motivated by media attention on the 'flattening the wrong curve' plot, tweeted a graph of a slow-moving Indian case-rise with a caption, 'frightening, not flattening'.[5] Close in line with President Obama's assessment, the info-graphic which he tweeted neither demonstrated fast-rising cases, nor a vertical caseload—something which we would have seen as early as May, had the lockdown not been announced, leading to mass deaths. As we may see further too,